

Carbohydrate provides more than half of the calories in the diet.

The brain cells contain little glycogen and depend on a continuous supply of glucose for their high metabolic activity.

Digestion and absorption of Carbohydrates

Salivary amylase aids digestion of starch in the mouth. Most of the digestion of carbohydrates takes place in the small intestine. Carbohydrates are absorbed into the blood stream as glucose, Galactose and fructose. By way of the capillaries of the villi, the simple sugars enter the portal circulation and transported to the liver.

Dietary Fibre

The carbohydrates (E.g, pectin, cellulose, hemicellulose) and some non carbohydrates substances (e.g. lignin) are collectively called as dietary fibre. Fibre is found in vegetables, fruits and grains. It resists digestion.

The most practical ways of including sufficient fibre in diet are:

- Whole cereals should be preferred to refined cereals
- Whole pulses should be preferred to those from which the husk has been removed
- Fruits and vegetables can be eaten with the skin intact.

Significance of Fibre

High fibre diet plays an important role in prevention and management of constipation (Inability to pass motion/ lack of bowel movement)

Fibre also helps to reduce blood cholesterol

Helps to prevent blood glucose level after food (Post prandial blood glucose)

II. Proteins

Proteins are the indispensible constituents of the diet. Proteins are made up of amino acids. Amino acids are needed for replacement and growth of the body parts.

Amino acids are classified as essential and non essential amino acids. Essential amino acids cannot be synthesized by the body and must be taken through foods whereas non essential amino acids can be synthesized by the body.

Amino acids contain carbon, hydrogen, oxygen and nitrogen in their chemical composition.

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